

Bob Ingram

'As I Was Saying ...'

Lee Looks Toward Houston

OPENING PITCH. And what ever happened to the El Paso-Juarez monorail? Signs of something or other: Holding a track meet to the beat of a bongo drum. Name similarities: Podres and Padres (Johnny Podres and the team he pitches for, the San Diego Padres). What they're doing now: Gordie Avery, flashy little second baseman of the Sun Kings in 1967 and 1968, is running a restaurant in his hometown of Sutherlin, Ore. Week's quote of note, by Lee Trevino, on the forthcoming U.S. Open, of which he's the defending champion, at Houston: "The Houston course is my type of course. Lee's Fleas will pack the galleries. I'll have more Mexicans watching me than Pancho Villa ever saw." Many pitchers are walking banks. They have calcium deposits. Noted outs: tap.....,board, three strikes and you're.....,ter Mongolia, cast, cry. Did you know that Del Rice's San Jose team last year won 17 games in a row at one stretch, lost one and then won 11 in a row? Wally Wolf, the Sun Kings pitcher, is wearing contacts this year instead of glasses. Signs of progress: Aluminum bats in softball. They may be used next in baseball. Did you know that Dick Miller, the Sun Kings radio broadcaster, may sue if a typographical error results in the "o" being dropped and he's called the "The Vice of The Sun Kings?"

What the Fans Didn't Hear

THE CONVERSATION between Del Rice, manager of the Sun Kings, and umpire Hank Burmester in the fifth inning over a play at first base: Rice—"You're a lousy umpire if you can't call a play better than this." Burmester—"Are you calling me a lousy umpire?" Rice—"You are if you make calls like that." On his way out of the game, Rice kicked home plate and knocked the helmets off the Sun Kings dugout. On the play in question, Bobby Trevino hit a liner that almost undressed first baseman Gary Moore of the Dodgers. It was so hot Moore couldn't hang onto the ball. He tossed to pitcher Jeff Zahn for the out. Zahn dropped the ball but the umpire ruled he held it long enough. Rice was tossed out of three games last season. The Los Angeles Dodgers had good opening nights. The big club beat Houston last night in the Astros' home opener. Spokane defeated Tucson in a Pacific Coast League opener. And the Albuquerque Dodgers defeated El Paso last night in a Texas League opener. Chuck Tanner won his opener in the PCL, the Hawaiian Islanders defeating Tacoma 4-2. Jack Lee, the old basketball broadcaster who used to rip into the officials on occasions, is in El Paso—to help broadcast the Albuquerque-El Paso series back to Duke City. The golfers in the Masters yesterday were handicapped by the pin placements which were in tough spots on the greens. Would you say the players were pinned down?

Vic Is Up for Umpteenth Time

VIC ROZNOVSKY, who caught, played third base and played outfield for the Sun Kings in their early days in the Texas League, has been up and down more than a roller coaster. The Cubs and Baltimore Orioles would keep him awhile, send him down, bring him back, etc. Now's he got a new big lease on life. The Philadelphia Phils have just bought him. What, no homers at Dudley Field last night in the opener? The wind was blowing in and it was almost cold. The bad weather probably cut the crowd by 1000. Blackie Sherrod of the Dallas Times Herald says, "gal riders are the biggest thing in racing since Dancer's Image flunked his potty test." The Texas League umps last night didn't get to show up their bright turtle-necks. Because of the weather, they wore gold windbreakers. They did show their colorful red and white caps. In 1883, Art Irwin caught a baseball that stung his bare hand very badly. He danced around, holding his burning hand and exploding with a few bad words. He decided he was going to do something about it. So, he invented the first fielder's glove in baseball.

DODGERS (NO. 1 IN SERIES)

They're not the least big foggy
Although star quarterback Sogge
Catches and doesn't throw the ball
Nearly as much as he does in the fall.